

MSSE Capstone Project

Final Release Readiness, Feature Freeze & Presentation Planning Meeting Minutes

TrustAI Marketplace

Date	August 26, 2026
Time	Approximately 7:03 PM CAT / 10:03 AM PDT
Duration	Approximately 23 minutes
Location	Virtual team meeting
Meeting Type	Final-stage alignment, release readiness, feature-freeze discussion, documentation closeout and presentation planning
Prepared For	TrustAI Marketplace MSSE Capstone team records

1. Attendees and Meeting Roles

Four members participated in the August 26 call. The meeting began with three participants, and Samar joined after the formal discussion had started. Adrian was unable to attend and was expected to catch up from the written minutes and team messages afterward.

Team member	Role / participation in this meeting
Ahmed Al-Mandalawi	Product Owner / AI Analysis Lead. Participated in final submission planning, release priorities and the open-issues discussion; provided the current status of issue #86 / PR #90 and the production deployment problem.
Ranga Nyamadzawo	Backend/platform and architecture contributor. Framed the project as substantially complete, proposed the final walkthrough and rehearsal approach, and led the discussion on feature freeze and the treatment of open issues.
Mulima Chibuye	Scrum Master / Project Manager. Participated in the rubric, Trello, submission and presentation-format discussion and helped define the remaining coordination work.
Samar El Ghandour	QA / DevOps lead. Joined after the meeting had started and participated in the release-readiness discussion. The production environment and deployment workflow remained part of her primary workstream.
Adrian Muchatibaya	Frontend lead. Unable to attend this call; to catch up through the minutes and team communication.

2. Meeting Objective

The meeting was held at the point where the project was approaching the finish line. The team was no longer trying to decide the basic architecture or deployment direction. Instead, it needed one shared view of the remaining work and a controlled plan for finishing the submission without creating another round of unnecessary scope.

- Establish what was actually complete and what still needed attention before submission.
- Separate release-critical work from enhancements that could be deferred beyond the Capstone MVP.
- Make sure the full team could navigate and explain the application, architecture and deployment flow.
- Plan the 15–20 minute group presentation so each member had a clear, non-overlapping contribution.
- Agree on a practical feature-freeze approach and how to handle legitimate open issues.

- Finish the repository, task-board and documentation housekeeping needed for a clean final submission.

3. Project Position Entering the August 26 Meeting

The August 26 meeting represented the final phase of a project that had changed considerably since the kickoff. The team's earlier records show a deliberate progression from scope selection and setup, through implementation and integration, into a live production system. This context mattered because the group was now deciding what to stop building and what to polish.

Project stage	Position reached before August 26
Kickoff / early July	TrustAI Marketplace was selected as the team Capstone. Ahmed became Product Owner and Mulima Scrum Master. The product was defined as a marketplace-buyer decision-support tool focused on explainable listing risk and practical next steps.
Sprint 0 planning	The MVP was narrowed to authentication, listing submission, text-based analysis, price plausibility, results/history, testing, documentation and deployment. Image analysis, browser-extension work and broad marketplace integrations were kept outside the core MVP.
Sprint 0 review / Sprint 1 start	React, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, Docker and GitHub Actions were confirmed. The team adopted clear bounded contexts, shared API contracts, a provider-independent analysis layer, task branches, peer review and Trello ownership.
July 22 implementation phase	Database schema and migrations, login/frontend work and analysis-provider work were progressing. The team acknowledged that it was behind and needed to accelerate while keeping the agreed wireframes and contracts stable.
August 6 recovery / deployment alignment	The application was broadly working locally. Slow PR merging, stale branches and Trello drift were recognized as delivery risks. The team aligned on AWS deployment using GitHub Actions, OIDC, ECR and EC2, with deployment work becoming part of the critical path.
August 8–12 production transition	The frontend and backend were deployed to AWS and automated deployment was working. The pipeline was strengthened further so the server could be managed through AWS Systems Manager rather than relying on an exposed SSH-based process.
August 16–17 hardening	Production testing exposed regressions and missing frontend coverage. HTTPS/domain work progressed. A deployment also failed because the EC2 instance ran out of disk space while Docker was pulling a new image; manual cleanup restored capacity and a recurring cleanup change was proposed.
August 17–23 analysis and release hardening	Live testing exposed two important analysis limitations: the application was text-only and could not treat unseen images as missing, and newer products could be mishandled when outside a model's existing knowledge. The team added clearer boundaries, user-facing limitations, stronger tests and then a backend evidence-policy validation layer.
August 20–23 operational review	The team discovered that the scheduled database backup path had never been fully configured or proven. Rather than overstate resilience, the issue was kept open while the group considered whether backup/recovery belonged in the MVP or post-MVP work. By August 23, most Trello items were documentation/delivery work rather than major new features.

Project stage	Position reached before August 26
Final-stage context Ranga estimated during the meeting that roughly 90% of the planned work had been covered. The group treated this as a practical status estimate, not a measured completion figure. The important point was that the remaining work had shifted from building the product to organizing, validating, documenting and presenting the product already delivered.	

4. Opening Check-In and Remaining Program Work

The call opened with a short informal check-in about the final MSSE specializations and the remaining program timeline. Some members had completed their remaining specialization work, while others were still finishing one final specialization. The group also briefly discussed continued access to course material and graduation logistics.

Although this was not a Capstone decision, it reinforced the capacity pressure already seen in the August 6 meeting: the final project work was happening at the same time as other program obligations. By this point, however, the team was clearly treating the remaining period as a release-and-submission window rather than a normal sprint.

5. Completion Assessment and Final MVP Boundary

Once the formal discussion began, the team focused on getting a clear picture of what everyone was doing, what still mattered for the Capstone, and who owned the remaining work. Ranga's view was that the majority of implementation was already complete and the remaining job was to "put the house in order."

That meant revisiting the board against the system that had actually been delivered. Earlier in the project, the team had intentionally reduced scope where an item would add too much effort or risk for the available schedule. The final-stage plan was to preserve that discipline rather than reopen features just because they were technically interesting.

- Confirm which original backlog items were delivered as part of the MVP.
- Clearly mark work that was cancelled, deferred or converted into post-MVP enhancement ideas.
- Avoid adding new functionality that could destabilize the live application during the submission window.
- Keep already-planned release-critical fixes moving where they directly improve correctness or stability.
- Use the final board and documentation to show the real evolution of the project, not an idealized plan that no longer matches the code.

6. Full-Team Walkthrough of the Deployed Application

Ranga proposed that the team schedule a dedicated session in which one member shares the screen and the group walks through the full application together. The purpose would be both technical and presentational: everyone should understand how the product behaves, what the main user flow looks like, and how the workstreams fit together before the final recording.

This was especially important because the final presentation is a team presentation. The group did not want a situation where one person could explain only frontend work, another only deployment, and another only analysis. Each member should be able to follow the complete product story even if their presentation segment focuses on a specific contribution.

- Navigate the production application from the user's perspective rather than relying only on local environments.
- Review the main functional flow, including authentication, listing submission, analysis/results and history where applicable.
- Use the walkthrough to surface any final presentation-blocking defect before feature freeze.
- Review the architecture and deployment flow while the application is open so presenters can connect implementation decisions to visible behavior.
- Make sure all members are comfortable with the current product before presentation roles are finalized.

7. Final Presentation Structure

The group then discussed how to use the very limited presentation time. The working understanding was that the recording should run approximately 15–20 minutes. With five members, that leaves roughly three minutes or less per person once the introduction, product demonstration and handoffs are taken into account.

The preferred format was a single coordinated presentation rather than five separate mini-presentations. One person would open with a concise introduction to TrustAI Marketplace and the team, explain what was built and why, and then move into the system architecture. From there, each member would cover a key contribution or responsibility before the group closed with the final product state and outcome.

- Product introduction: what TrustAI Marketplace is, the buyer problem it addresses and the MVP delivered.
- Architecture: how the frontend, backend, database, analysis layer and production deployment fit together.
- Individual contribution segments: each team member speaks to one distinct area rather than repeating the same project overview.
- Live application demonstration: show the actual product working instead of relying on a presentation made primarily of slides.
- Short closeout: summarize what was achieved, the engineering practices demonstrated and any clearly identified future enhancements.

Presentation principle

The team agreed that the recording should be scripted enough to be clear and efficient, but it should still sound like a real group presentation. The goal was to avoid rambling, repeated points and awkward handoffs without turning the delivery into a stiff line-by-line recital.

8. Presentation Script, Rehearsals and Timed Dry Runs

Ranga recommended that the group first meet over the weekend for one to two hours to brainstorm the final talking points and assign the speaking sections. After that, the team should run multiple timed mock presentations. These rehearsals would allow the team to check the pace, transitions, technical navigation and overall clarity before recording the final submission.

The group discussed recording the practice runs. If a rehearsal turned out exceptionally well, it could be kept as a candidate, but the main value of the dry runs was to make the final recording predictable and comfortable.

- Agree the presentation order and exact owner of each section before recording.
- Write concise talking points and transitions so the next speaker knows exactly where to enter.
- Run the full presentation from beginning to end without stopping to test the real timing.
- Record practice runs and review where the group repeats information, loses time or creates awkward pauses.
- Prepare every browser tab, application page, diagram or repository view before the run starts to reduce navigation delay.
- Repeat the dry run until the whole team can stay inside the target time while still demonstrating the product properly.

9. Current Analysis Work: Issue #86 and PR #90

Ahmed reported that his main recent work had been issue #86 and that the latest review feedback had been addressed, with the relevant checks passing. This work was part of the final hardening of the analysis path rather than a new feature.

The issue originated from live testing of a newer product. The application could incorrectly treat unfamiliar or unverified product information as evidence of fraud or non-existence. The first correction tightened the knowledge boundary and added a clear limitation notice for users. A later production test showed that a

structurally valid response could still contain unsupported risk reasoning, so the team narrowed the approach further.

PR #90 added a backend evidence-policy check after the existing schema validation. The intent was to reject known unsupported reasoning before it could be saved or displayed, while preserving the public API, database schema and frontend behavior. The existing retry-once / fail-closed path remained in place so the application would prefer a failed analysis over presenting unsupported risk claims as fact.

- Keep unfamiliarity or lack of current knowledge from automatically increasing risk.
- Continue allowing genuine scam signals present in the listing text to affect the analysis normally.
- Reject unsupported evidence before it becomes a persisted or user-visible result.
- Keep broader web-grounding and real-time pricing intelligence as future enhancements unless deliberately approved after the Capstone release.

10. Production Deployment Status and EC2 Disk-Space Problem

The main operational problem raised during the meeting was repeated deployment failure caused by the EC2 instance running out of storage. Old Docker images and related deployment artifacts were accumulating instead of being cleaned up reliably. Ahmed reported recovering approximately one gigabyte of space during troubleshooting and checking the database, which appeared healthy.

This was a recurrence of the August 17 deployment failure, when the instance reached “no space left on device” while pulling a new image. At that time the team manually removed unused images and volumes and added a cleanup change to the deployment process. Because the problem appeared again, the team could not treat the cleanup behavior as permanently solved without another verification pass.

- Keep the live production environment stable while the cleanup problem is corrected.
- Verify the cleanup step actually removes stale Docker artifacts across deployments rather than only working once.
- Check free disk space before the final presentation/rehearsal so a deployment does not fail immediately before recording.
- Document the issue and the verified resolution accurately in the deployment/testing record.

11. Feature Freeze and the Treatment of Open Issues

The team agreed that the project needed a feature freeze for submission. A Trello card already existed for this purpose. The discussion then turned to what “freeze” should mean in practice and whether all open issues should be closed before the final submission.

One view was to spend only a couple more days on code and then close everything so the group could concentrate entirely on documentation and presentation. Ranga challenged the idea of closing issues simply for appearance. His point was that software continues to evolve and a legitimate open issue can be evidence that the team found, recorded and managed a defect rather than ignored it.

The practical direction was to freeze new scope, not erase the project’s remaining engineering work. A real defect or improvement could remain open if it was understood, documented and not blocking the required user stories or the final demonstration. Work that had already been planned and was small enough to complete safely could still be finished before the release was frozen.

- Stop adding new discretionary features to the submission release.
- Finish release-critical fixes that are already understood and can be completed safely.
- Do not close a genuine issue merely to create an empty issue list.
- Keep non-blocking defects and enhancements visible as known limitations or future work where appropriate.
- Use the presentation and documentation to be transparent about the final MVP boundary and any remaining work.

12. Rubric-Driven Final Priorities

The group repeatedly came back to the Capstone rubric as the final decision-making tool. The team's view was that the project already had sufficient technical depth; the remaining risk was failing to present and document that work clearly enough for the grader to see it.

The final priorities were therefore not simply “close every issue.” The team wanted to make sure the deployed application was reliable, the documentation was current, the project board reflected reality, and the presentation showed both the working product and the engineering practices used to build it.

Area to finish	What the team wanted ready for submission
Working application	A stable, demonstrable production build with the main user flow functioning and no known presentation-blocking defect.
Repository	Current code, clean documentation, understandable architecture/design records and a coherent final release state.
Testing / quality	Evidence that important backend, contract, frontend and production behaviors were tested, including the issues discovered during hardening.
CI/CD / deployment	A clear explanation of the automated AWS deployment workflow and the operational lessons learned from production testing.
Trello / project management	Accurate owners, statuses, Done/Cancelled items, open work and traceability back to implemented changes.
Presentation	A rehearsed 15–20 minute team demonstration with distinct speaking roles and a live view of the product.

13. Trello Board and Submission Evidence

The team asked how the Trello board would be shown to the grader and whether access would require a separate account. Screenshots were mentioned as one possible way to show the board, but the group agreed that the exact submission requirement needed to be checked rather than assumed.

Regardless of the access method, the board itself needed to be cleaned up before submission. Earlier meetings had already identified missing owners and stale card states, and the final board now also needed to distinguish delivered work from cancelled or deferred scope. The goal was for another person to look at Trello and understand what the team planned, what it actually completed and what remained.

- Review every remaining card for a real owner and current status.
- Move completed work to Done and explicitly mark work that was cancelled or deferred.
- Keep the feature-freeze card visible and set the freeze timing once the team agrees on the date.
- Use issue/PR references where useful so the project-management record can be correlated with implementation history.
- Confirm the final method for giving the grader access to the board before submission.

14. Final Repository and Documentation Sanity Check

The team agreed that the repository needed a final pass before submission. The goal was not to rewrite the project history, but to make sure the documentation created throughout development still matched the final implementation and that no important design, testing or access detail was missing.

This continued a working agreement from the July meetings: documentation should be built alongside the project rather than recreated at the end. The final-stage task was therefore reconciliation and polish.

- Read the final architecture/design documentation against the code that is actually deployed.

- Update deployment descriptions so they reflect the final AWS workflow rather than earlier Render/VPS ideas that were superseded.
- Keep the analysis limitations and evidence-policy decisions documented consistently with the behavior visible in the application.
- Make sure testing records reflect what was actually run and avoid claiming unverified behavior.
- Confirm the deployment link, repository access and project-board access required for grading.
- Keep known limitations such as any unresolved backup/recovery work clearly distinguished from completed capabilities.

15. Decisions and Working Agreements

ID	Decision / working agreement	Why it mattered
A26-01	Treat the project as being in final release/submission mode.	The majority of the MVP was complete and the remaining schedule needed to protect quality, documentation and presentation preparation.
A26-02	Reconcile the original backlog with the MVP actually delivered.	The final Trello board and documentation should show delivered, cancelled/deferred and still-open work honestly.
A26-03	Hold a full-team walkthrough of the deployed application before the final recording.	Every presenter needs a practical understanding of the whole product, not only their own workstream.
A26-04	Script the presentation and assign distinct speaking sections.	The 15–20 minute limit is too short for improvised or repetitive handoffs.
A26-05	Run multiple timed, recorded practice presentations.	Rehearsals will expose timing, navigation and speaking issues before the submission recording.
A26-06	Move to feature freeze after the remaining release-critical work.	New scope should not destabilize the production application during the submission window.
A26-07	Do not automatically close legitimate open issues.	Known defects and enhancements can remain visible if they are non-blocking, understood and properly documented.
A26-08	Use the Capstone rubric to prioritize the final work.	Effort should be directed toward the assessed software, evidence, project-management record and presentation rather than nonessential enhancements.
A26-09	Complete a final repository/documentation/access review.	The submission should present one coherent story across code, documentation, Trello and the deployed application.

16. Action Items

Owner	Action	Timing / status
Ahmed Al-Mandalawi	Close the loop on issue #86 / PR #90 review feedback and keep the final evidence-policy behavior and tests aligned with the approved scope.	Immediate / release-critical
Ahmed Al-Mandalawi	Maintain the August 26 meeting record so the full team, including Adrian, has the same final-stage plan.	Immediate

Owner	Action	Timing / status
Ahmed Al-Mandalawi + team	Continue production-oriented analysis testing with representative benign, suspicious and newer-product cases before the final demo.	Before feature freeze
Ranga Nyamadzawo	Help lead the final architecture/application walkthrough and presentation-planning session.	Weekend session
Ranga Nyamadzawo / Samar El Ghandour	Resolve and verify the EC2 Docker cleanup/disk-space problem so repeated deployments do not exhaust the instance.	Release-critical
Mulima Chibuye	Reconcile the Trello board with the final MVP: Done, Cancelled/deferred, current issues, owners and feature-freeze state.	Before submission
Mulima Chibuye + team	Confirm the exact method required to make the agile board available to the grader.	Before submission
Samar El Ghandour	Support final deployment validation and confirm the production environment is stable for rehearsals and recording.	Before final recording
Adrian Muchatibaya	Catch up from the minutes, confirm the final frontend state and prepare the frontend/design segment for the group presentation.	Before rehearsal
Entire team	Meet over the weekend for a full application walkthrough, presentation script and speaking-role allocation.	Weekend; exact day to confirm
Entire team	Run at least two timed mock presentations and review the recordings for timing, clarity and navigation.	Before final recording
Entire team	Complete the final repository/documentation/access audit and then freeze new feature scope for the submission release.	Before final recording/submission

17. Risks and Delivery Concerns

Risk / issue	Current concern	Response
Presentation time	Five members, a live product demonstration and the engineering story must fit into 15–20 minutes.	Use a scripted run-of-show and full timed rehearsals.
Uneven system familiarity	Work has been distributed across frontend, backend, analysis and DevOps.	Run the full-team walkthrough and make every presenter exercise the live application.
EC2 disk exhaustion	The production host has already failed deployments because stale Docker artifacts consumed storage, and the cleanup problem resurfaced.	Fix and verify cleanup; check free space before final recording.
Analysis evidence quality	Live testing has shown that validly structured responses can still contain unsupported reasoning.	Keep the evidence-policy validation, retry/fail-closed path and representative production checks.
Documentation drift	The project moved through several architecture/deployment decisions during July and August.	Audit final docs against the actual production implementation.

Risk / issue	Current concern	Response
Trello drift	Earlier cards have had stale ownership/status and some original scope has been cancelled or superseded.	Complete final board cleanup and preserve the history honestly.
Open-issue optics	There is a temptation to close issues purely to look complete.	Keep real non-blocking issues visible and document their status/future treatment.
Backup/recovery ambiguity	A backup workflow existed but a complete off-instance recovery path had not been proven.	Do not describe backup/recovery as completed unless it is actually implemented and tested.
Attendance / scheduling	The team works across multiple time zones and one member missed this meeting.	Lock rehearsals and final recording early enough to ensure full participation.

18. Open Questions and Items to Confirm

- What exact date and time will the feature freeze take effect? The team agreed on the need for a freeze but did not set the date during this call.
- Which weekend day will be used for the walkthrough and first presentation dry run? Sunday was preferred in the discussion, but the closing exchange was inconsistent, so the team should confirm the final date in the group chat.
- What is the final merge status of PR #90 after the reported review changes and passing checks? The meeting did not establish a completed merge.
- Has the EC2 cleanup defect been permanently fixed and verified across another deployment? The meeting only confirmed the problem and manual recovery.
- Will backup/recovery remain documented post-MVP work, or will the team complete and verify a simple recovery option before submission?
- Which artifacts beyond the live application will be shown in the final recording: architecture diagram, CI/CD workflow, Trello board, testing evidence or selected repository views?
- What is the final speaker order, and who will open and close the recording? The Product Owner-led introduction was suggested, but final assignment was deferred to the rehearsal session.

19. Planned Agenda for the Weekend Walkthrough / Presentation Session

The August 26 call intentionally left the detailed run-of-show for a follow-up session. Based on the decisions made in the meeting, the team's next working session should cover the following in one continuous sequence:

- Confirm attendance, remaining release-critical issues and the feature-freeze target.
- Walk through the deployed application from login/registration through listing analysis and saved results/history.
- Test a small set of representative listings, including a clearly benign case, a case with explicit scam signals and a newer-product case relevant to the knowledge/evidence boundary.
- Confirm production health and verify that deployment storage/cleanup is safe before rehearsals.
- Review the final architecture and agree on the shortest accurate explanation of frontend, backend, PostgreSQL, analysis provider interface and AWS deployment.
- Decide which CI/CD and testing evidence is worth showing within the presentation time limit.
- Review Trello and mark final Done, Cancelled/deferred and open items.
- Assign speaking sections and write the transitions between speakers.
- Run the first timed mock presentation without stopping.
- Review the recording, fix timing/navigation problems, and run at least one more full rehearsal.

20. Project Evidence to Preserve Through Submission

The team has accumulated a strong project record across planning, implementation, testing and deployment. The final documentation should preserve the evidence that explains how the finished application evolved rather than showing only the final website.

- The kickoff, Sprint 0, Sprint 1, July 22/August 6 and August 26 meeting minutes.
- Trello history showing sprint assignment, ownership, Done/Cancelled states and the final feature-freeze position.
- Architecture-alignment records and the resulting contract/design decisions.
- Database schema and migration history and the Docker startup/integration fixes.
- Pull-request reviews, branch protection, CI quality gates and release/versioning history.
- AWS deployment documentation showing the final automated pipeline and production environment.
- Production testing evidence, including the EC2 disk-space incident and the verified cleanup outcome once complete.
- Analysis-boundary work around text-only behavior, recent-product knowledge limits and the final evidence-policy validation.
- Automated backend, contract and frontend test evidence and the regression tests added during hardening.
- Backup/recovery issue history so the final report does not claim an unverified capability.
- Wireframes/design artifacts and the final frontend implementation.
- Presentation rehearsal recordings and the final submitted demonstration.

21. Next Meeting

The team agreed to meet again over the weekend for the presentation walkthrough and dry-run work. The usual evening slot was considered acceptable. The exact weekend day should be confirmed in the team chat because the closing conversation contained conflicting references to Saturday and Sunday.

Next-session priority

The next call is not intended to become another open-ended development meeting. Its purpose is to finalize the release view of the product, rehearse the demonstration, assign presentation roles and surface only the issues that could materially affect submission quality.

22. Closing Summary

The August 26 meeting marked the shift from active implementation toward a controlled final release. By that point, TrustAI Marketplace had progressed from the early project concept and repository foundation to an integrated application running in production, supported by the team's Git workflow, automated testing, documented architecture and AWS deployment work. Production testing had also exposed real defects and design limitations that were being handled as release-readiness work rather than hidden from the final project record.

The team's final-stage approach was therefore deliberately conservative. New scope would be frozen, remaining release-critical fixes would be completed where practical, legitimate open issues would remain visible instead of being hidden, and the task board and documentation would be reconciled with the actual software. The project would be presented as a working MVP with clear boundaries, not as a claim that every possible enhancement had been finished.

The remaining work was primarily about presentation quality and consistency: every member needed to understand the complete application, the final recording needed a clear 15–20 minute structure, and the repository, Trello board, tests, architecture and deployment story all needed to describe the same system. Multiple rehearsals and a full-team walkthrough were chosen as the final safeguard against a rushed or fragmented submission.